BRAINSTORMING AND DIMENSIONAL EXPANSION

DIVERGENT-TO-CONVERGENT FUNNEL → ACTOR LADDER → SCALE-TIME MATRIX → DOMAIN SEARCH FIELD → CAUSAL ARCHITECTURE → DIRECTION TEST

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ◇ SUBORDINATE EXTRA ★ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00 → STAGE 00

DIVERGENT-TO-CONVERGENT FUNNEL

DIVERGENT-TO-CONVERGENT FUNNEL | DECODED PROMPT | GENERATE CANDIDATE CLAIMS | MECHANISM + EVIDENCE + LIMIT | COHERENT ARGUMENT CLUSTERS

DECODED PROMPT → DIVERGE → generate candidate claims → FILTER → mechanism + evidence + limit → CONVERGE → coherent argument clusters

PRINTED PROMPT / STARTING CLAIM
- DECODED PROMPT
- DIVERGE → generate candidate claims

DECODING / SCOPING / ARGUMENT MOVE
- FILTER → mechanism + evidence + limit
- CONVERGE → coherent argument clusters

COUNTER-CASE / QUALIFICATION / SYNTHESIS
- DECODED PROMPT
- DIVERGE → generate candidate claims

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: FILTER → mechanism + evidence + limit; CONVERGE → coherent argument clusters.

01 → STAGE 01

ACTOR LADDER

ACTOR LADDER | FAMILY OR COMMUNITY | GLOBAL ORDER | KEEP ONLY | LEVELS THAT CHANGE CLAIM OR MECHANISM

INDIVIDUAL → FAMILY OR COMMUNITY

INSTITUTION → STATE → GLOBAL ORDER → CIVILISATION → KEEP ONLY → levels that change claim or mechanism

PRINTED PROMPT / STARTING CLAIM
- INDIVIDUAL → FAMILY OR COMMUNITY
- INSTITUTION → STATE

DECODING / SCOPING / ARGUMENT MOVE
- GLOBAL ORDER → CIVILISATION
- KEEP ONLY → levels that change claim or mechanism

COUNTER-CASE / QUALIFICATION / SYNTHESIS
- INDIVIDUAL → FAMILY OR COMMUNITY
- INSTITUTION → STATE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: KEEP ONLY → levels that change claim or mechanism.

02 → STAGE 02

SCALE-TIME MATRIX

SCALE-TIME MATRIX | LOCAL TO NATIONAL | PROXIMITY AND INSTITUTIONS | GLOBAL TO CIVILISATIONAL | SYSTEMS AND LONG-RUN PATTERN | PAST TO PRESENT | CONTINUITY AND CHANGE | PLAUSIBLE TRAJECTORY, NOT PREDICTION

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE	DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION	DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT
LOCAL TO NATIONAL → proximity and institutions	PAST TO PRESENT → continuity and change	LOCAL TO NATIONAL → proximity and institutions
GLOBAL TO CIVILISATIONAL → systems and long-run pattern	FUTURE → plausible trajectory, not prediction	GLOBAL TO CIVILISATIONAL → systems and long-run pattern

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE
- LOCAL TO NATIONAL → proximity and institutions
- GLOBAL TO CIVILISATIONAL → systems and long-run pattern

DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION
- PAST TO PRESENT → continuity and change
- FUTURE → plausible trajectory, not prediction

DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT
- LOCAL TO NATIONAL → proximity and institutions
- GLOBAL TO CIVILISATIONAL → systems and long-run pattern

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: GLOBAL TO CIVILISATIONAL → systems and long-run pattern.

03 → STAGE 03

DOMAIN SEARCH FIELD

DOMAIN SEARCH FIELD | SOCIAL + ECONOMIC + POLITICAL | ETHICAL + CULTURAL | TECHNOLOGICAL + ECOLOGICAL | LENS EARNS ENTRY ONLY THROUGH A DISTINCT CLAIM

SOCIAL + ECONOMIC + POLITICAL

ETHICAL + CULTURAL → TECHNOLOGICAL + ECOLOGICAL → RULE → lens earns entry only through a distinct claim

PROMPT READING / CENTRAL TENSION
- SOCIAL + ECONOMIC + POLITICAL
- ETHICAL + CULTURAL

ARGUMENT / DIMENSION / EVIDENCE USE
- TECHNOLOGICAL + ECOLOGICAL
- RULE → lens earns entry only through a distinct claim

TOPIC-DRIFT / ATTRIBUTION / FORMULA LIMIT
- SOCIAL + ECONOMIC + POLITICAL
- ETHICAL + CULTURAL

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → lens earns entry only through a distinct claim.

04 → STAGE 04

CAUSAL ARCHITECTURE

CAUSAL ARCHITECTURE | IMMEDIATE CAUSE | STRUCTURAL CAUSE | DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT | NOT EVERY PROMPT REQUIRES THE WHOLE CHAIN

PRINTED PROMPT / STARTING CLAIM
- IMMEDIATE CAUSE → STRUCTURAL CAUSE
- IMPACT → DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

DECODING / SCOPING / ARGUMENT MOVE
- RESPONSE → FEEDBACK
- LIMIT → not every prompt requires the whole chain

COUNTER-CASE / QUALIFICATION / SYNTHESIS
- IMMEDIATE CAUSE → STRUCTURAL CAUSE
- IMPACT → DISTRIBUTIONAL EFFECT

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → not every prompt requires the whole chain.

05 → STAGE 05

DIRECTION TEST

DIRECTION TEST | INTENDED BENEFIT | UNINTENDED CONSEQUENCE | WHO GAINS OR LOSES | CONDITIONS CHANGING THE BALANCE

INTENDED BENEFIT → UNINTENDED CONSEQUENCE → WHO GAINS OR LOSES → SYNTHESIS → conditions changing the balance

PROMPT READING / CENTRAL TENSION
- INTENDED BENEFIT
- UNINTENDED CONSEQUENCE

ARGUMENT / DIMENSION / EVIDENCE USE
- WHO GAINS OR LOSES
- SYNTHESIS → conditions changing the balance

TOPIC-DRIFT / ATTRIBUTION / FORMULA LIMIT
- INTENDED BENEFIT
- UNINTENDED CONSEQUENCE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WHO GAINS OR LOSES; SYNTHESIS → conditions changing the balance.

06 → STAGE 06

FRAMEWORK FIREWALL

FRAMEWORK FIREWALL | RECALL PROMPT | ACTOR OR DOMAIN GRID | SEARCH AID | COMPULSORY HEADINGS | PROMPT-SPECIFIC CLAIMS WITHOUT VISIBLE TEMPLATE

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE	DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION	DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT
PESTLE → recall prompt	COMPULSORY HEADINGS → reject	PESTLE → recall prompt
ACTOR OR DOMAIN GRID → search aid	OUTPUT → prompt-specific claims without visible template	ACTOR OR DOMAIN GRID → search aid

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE
- PESTLE → recall prompt
- ACTOR OR DOMAIN GRID → search aid

DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION
- COMPULSORY HEADINGS → reject
- OUTPUT → prompt-specific claims without visible template

DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT
- PESTLE → recall prompt
- ACTOR OR DOMAIN GRID → search aid

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: COMPULSORY HEADINGS → reject; OUTPUT → prompt-specific claims without visible template.

07 → STAGE 07

CLAIM DISTINCTION TEST

CLAIM DISTINCTION TEST | WRITE ONE SENTENCE PER DIMENSION | SAME CLAIM IN NEW WORDS? | NEW MECHANISM OR SCALE? | NO THESIS LINK?

WRITE ONE SENTENCE PER DIMENSION

SAME CLAIM IN NEW WORDS? → DELETE → NEW MECHANISM OR SCALE? → CONTINUE → NO THESIS LINK? → PARK

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE
- WRITE ONE SENTENCE PER DIMENSION
- SAME CLAIM IN NEW WORDS? → DELETE

DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION
- NEW MECHANISM OR SCALE? → CONTINUE
- NO THESIS LINK? → PARK

DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT
- WRITE ONE SENTENCE PER DIMENSION
- SAME CLAIM IN NEW WORDS? → DELETE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NEW MECHANISM OR SCALE? → CONTINUE; NO THESIS LINK? → PARK.

08 → STAGE 08

EVIDENCE-LIMIT CARD

EVIDENCE-LIMIT CARD | NAMED EVIDENCE | LIMIT OR COUNTER-CASE | COMPLETE CARD | ELIGIBLE FOR PRIORITISATION

CLAIM → MECHANISM

MECHANISM → NAMED EVIDENCE → EVIDENCE → LIMIT OR COUNTER-CASE → COMPLETE CARD → eligible for prioritisation

PRINTED PROMPT / STARTING CLAIM
- CLAIM → MECHANISM
- MECHANISM → NAMED EVIDENCE

DECODING / SCOPING / ARGUMENT MOVE
- EVIDENCE → LIMIT OR COUNTER-CASE
- COMPLETE CARD → eligible for prioritisation

COUNTER-CASE / QUALIFICATION / SYNTHESIS
- CLAIM → MECHANISM
- MECHANISM → NAMED EVIDENCE

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE → LIMIT OR COUNTER-CASE; COMPLETE CARD → eligible for prioritisation.

09 → STAGE 09

PRIORITISATION GRID

PRIORITISATION GRID | THESIS RELEVANCE | HIGH OR LOW | MECHANISM STRENGTH | CLEAR OR VAGUE | EVIDENCE SAFETY | SECURE OR RISKY | NEW ARGUMENT JOB

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE	DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION	DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT
THESIS RELEVANCE → high or low	EVIDENCE SAFETY → secure or risky	THESIS RELEVANCE → high or low
MECHANISM STRENGTH → clear or vague	NEW ARGUMENT JOB → distinct or redundant	MECHANISM STRENGTH → clear or vague

PROMPT / METHOD MOVE
- THESIS RELEVANCE → high or low
- MECHANISM STRENGTH → clear or vague

DECISIVE ESSAY DISTINCTION
- EVIDENCE SAFETY → secure or risky
- NEW ARGUMENT JOB → distinct or redundant

DRIFT / EVIDENCE / RULE LIMIT
- THESIS RELEVANCE → high or low
- MECHANISM STRENGTH → clear or vague

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE SAFETY → secure or risky; NEW ARGUMENT JOB → distinct or redundant.

10 → STAGE 10

CLUSTER BUILDER

CLUSTER BUILDER | RELATED CLAIMS | ONE MECHANISM CLUSTER | CLUSTER ONE | CLUSTER TWO | EXPANSION OR COMPLICATION | CLUSTER THREE | COUNTER-VIEW AND SYNTHESIS

RELATED CLAIMS → one mechanism cluster

CLUSTER ONE → foundation → CLUSTER TWO → expansion or complication → CLUSTER THREE → counter-view and synthesis

PROMPT READING / CENTRAL TENSION
- RELATED CLAIMS → one mechanism cluster
- CLUSTER ONE → foundation

ARGUMENT / DIMENSION / EVIDENCE USE
- CLUSTER TWO → expansion or complication
- CLUSTER THREE → counter-view and synthesis

TOPIC-DRIFT / ATTRIBUTION / FORMULA LIMIT
- RELATED CLAIMS → one mechanism cluster
- CLUSTER ONE → foundation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLUSTER TWO → expansion or complication; CLUSTER THREE → counter-view and synthesis.

11 → STAGE 11

BRAINSTORMING ANSWER SPINE

BRAINSTORMING ANSWER SPINE | DIVERGE ACROSS ACTOR SCALE TIME DOMAIN | TEST CAUSALITY DISTRIBUTION AND DIRECTION | WRITE CLAIMS | MAP EVIDENCE | MAP LIMITS

DIVERGE ACROSS ACTOR SCALE TIME DOMAIN → TEST CAUSALITY DISTRIBUTION AND DIRECTION → WRITE CLAIMS → MAP EVIDENCE → MAP LIMITS → PRIORITISE → CLUSTER → CUT → SEQUENCE

PROMPT READING / CENTRAL TENSION
- DIVERGE ACROSS ACTOR SCALE TIME DOMAIN
- TEST CAUSALITY DISTRIBUTION AND DIRECTION

ARGUMENT / DIMENSION / EVIDENCE USE
- WRITE CLAIMS → MAP EVIDENCE → MAP LIMITS
- PRIORITISE → CLUSTER → CUT → SEQUENCE

TOPIC-DRIFT / ATTRIBUTION / FORMULA LIMIT
- DIVERGE ACROSS ACTOR SCALE TIME DOMAIN
- TEST CAUSALITY DISTRIBUTION AND DIRECTION

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: WRITE CLAIMS → MAP EVIDENCE → MAP LIMITS.

E → EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT | GENUINE DIMENSION | YIELDS A DISTINCT CLAIM, TESTABLE INDEPENDENTLY | FALSE DIMENSION | A RELABELLING OF AN EXISTING DIMENSION IN | A GENERATIVE CATEGORY (SCALE, TIME, DOMAIN, DISTRIBUTIONAL | BREADTH VS. DEPTH | THE HIDDEN ASSUMPTION THAT MORE DIMENSIONS

OPTIONAL INTERPRETIVE / DIALECTICAL DEPTH
- Genuine dimension: yields a distinct claim, testable independently
- False dimension: a relabelling of an existing dimension in
- Axis: a generative category (scale, time, domain, distributional
- Breadth vs. depth: the hidden assumption that more dimensions

PROMPT, ATTRIBUTION OR OFFICIAL-RULE LIMIT
- Breadth vs. coherence: a distinct and more dangerous trade-off than
- Template completeness vs. relevance: the assumption that every
- NOT: Mechanical axis-listing (forcing scale, time, domain, and
- NOT: Duplicate-claim padding. → Protocol: run the Section 6 filter

COMPARATIVE ARGUMENT / STRUCTURE NUANCE
- NOT: Ignoring the distributional axis on prompts that clearly need
- Subject: Essay | Tier: Advanced | GS Paper: Essay (General Studies Paper — Essay, Mains).
- Core area: Disciplined dimension-generation using scale, time, domain and distributional axes together; detecting and pruning false expansion.
- Grounded in: UPSC Essay PYQ corpus — V1 directly verified locally for 2018–2025 and V2 carried-forward practice wording

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels